Fixing It

Teacher Guide · Topic 6 of 12 · Value: Responsible





At a glance	
Goal	Students know what to do after a mistake or accident: stop and look, say sorry for what happened, ask “How can I help?”, and help fix it. If a friend needs space, they give space and try again later.
Time	15 minutes in Morning Meeting, in place of the general lesson. Centers run during the week.
When	Teach after Topic 5, Getting a Grown-Up’s Attention. It finishes the Skills I Can Use set and prepares students for the Safe Choices topics that follow.
In the bundle	Student deck (7 slides, press N for notes) · Poster (letter and 11×17) · Center kit (sort, sequence, act it out, desk strips, coloring) · Mini book · Family half-sheet
Words we use	“Stop. Say sorry. Ask how I can help. Help fix it.” · “I’m sorry I ___.” · “How can I help?” · “Okay. I can help later.”

Before you teach

- Set up a short tower of three blocks or books for the practice. Keep the bump soft and slow, and never knock over real student work.
- Decide how you will respond to a sorry all week: “Thank you for fixing it.” Keep it short and warm.
- Hang the poster at child height near your meeting space or block center. Students point to it all week.
- Do not force a sorry. A child who is upset can take a breath first, then help fix it.
- Tape a desk strip at the table of any student who often hides mistakes or blames others.
- Pair students who need support with a steady turn-and-talk partner before the lesson starts.

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The lesson, slide by slide

The same script is in the deck's presenter notes. Press N while presenting.

Slide	Say and do	Look for	Engagement move
1 · Title & Promise (R2)	"Everybody makes mistakes. What matters is what we do next." Say together: "Oops? I can fix it."	Students repeat the line in a calm voice.	Equity stick: "What is one mistake that can happen at school?"
2 · Get Calm First (R1)	Do it with them. "Smell the flower. Blow out the candle. Long and slow. Three times."	Exhale longer than inhale; shoulders drop.	LiveSchool point: "You breathed slow three times."
3 · What Did Lee Do? (R2, R3)	Point to each picture. "Lee bumped Kiara's tower by accident. She stopped and looked. She said, 'I'm sorry I knocked down your tower.' She asked, 'How can I help?' They built it again together." Class says: "Stop. Say sorry. Ask how I can help. Help fix it."	Students follow the pictures; whole class repeats the line.	Equity stick: "Which picture shows Lee asking how she can help? Point."
4 · Turn and Talk (R3, R4)	Model knee to knee. "The tower fell and Kiara is sad. Tell your partner: Lee can ___." 30 seconds, then two shares.	Partners take turns; any step on the slide is right.	Equity stick: two shares.
5 · Watch Me, Then Show Me (R3, R4, R5)	Bump a small tower softly and model all four steps. A student then shows the four steps while you play the friend. Practice the space rule once: "Not right now." "Okay. I can help later."	Stops and looks; sorry names what happened; calm ask; hands help fix it.	LiveSchool point for the student model.
6 · My Promise Today (R2, R5)	Hand on heart. "Say it with me: I can help make it right." Then: "When you make a mistake, point to one."	Every student says the promise and points to one picture.	Equity stick: three names. Pointing counts.
7 · How We Leave (R1, R4, R5)	"Stand up. Calm body. Walk. Ready to learn." Do not time this at K–2.	Calm bodies while moving; calm walking.	LiveSchool point for the table that walks with calm bodies the whole way.

Practice bridges for slide 5

Students model, not the teacher. The teacher narrates and asks the class what they saw.

If the model is...	Say
Excellent	"Show us again. Everyone, listen to how she says what happened."
Partly right	"You said sorry. Now ask, 'How can I help?' Try again."
Silly	"Thank you. Let's see it the real way." Call a new student. No commentary.

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Centers

Print one kit per group. Laminate the mats and cards so they last. Students work in groups of 2 to 4.

Center	Set up	Read to students	Done looks like
Sort It	Sort mat (landscape page) and 8 cut picture cards.	"Look at each picture. Is this friend fixing it? Put it on the side where it goes."	4 cards on Fixing it, 4 on Not fixing it. Accept any sort a student can explain.
Put It in Order	Sequencing mat and 4 cut cards.	"Put Lee's story in order: first, next, then, last. Tell your partner the story."	Students retell: oops, I am sorry, how can I help, we fixed it.
Act It Out	4 role-play cards in a stack.	"Pick a card. Read it with me. Show me how you help make it right."	Each student stops, says sorry for what happened, and shows a fix.
How I Fix It Steps	Desk strips, one per student.	"Point to each step and say it."	Each student says all four steps.
Color	Coloring page and crayons.	"Color Lee. Then show how you help fix it."	A colored page and one fix the student can name.

Answer keys

- **Sort, Fixing it:** Lee stops and looks · Lee says sorry · Lee and Kiara rebuild the tower · Tee picks up the crayons he spilled.
- **Sort, Not fixing it:** Diego laughs at a fallen tower · Sofia blames someone else · Malik walks away from crayons he spilled · Nadege throws a block.
- **Put It in Order:** 1 Lee bumps the tower · 2 Lee says sorry · 3 Lee asks how she can help · 4 Lee and Kiara fixed the tower.

The mini book (one child, Tier 2)

- For a child who hides mistakes, blames others, or freezes after an accident, and who needs a calm, safe way to make it right.
- Read it one-on-one at a calm time. Practice each step as you read it, with a small real fix like stacking two blocks.
- Read it every day for a week. Let the child turn the pages and say the sorry line on page 3.
- On the back, the child colors a star each time they help make it right. Celebrate every star.

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When fixing it gets tricky

Follows the Responsive Behavior Plan: the adult response is the intervention. Fewer words as escalation rises.

1. **A student says "It wasn't me."** Stay calm and skip the question of blame: "Something fell. Let's fix it together." Fixing it first lowers the fear.
2. **A student will not say sorry.** Do not force it. "Take a breath. You can help fix it first." A sorry can come later, or as a picture or a note.
3. **A friend is still upset.** Coach the space rule: "Your friend needs space. You can try again later." Check back in a few minutes.
4. **A student says a quick "sorry" and runs off.** "Thank you. Now tell her what happened and ask how you can help." Walk them through it once.
5. **A student is unsafe.** Safety first. Use Topic 7, Gentle Hands, and the Responsive Behavior Plan.

Next in the toolkit: Topic 7, Gentle Hands with Friends.

Family connection

- Send the family half-sheet home the day you teach. It is in English, Spanish, and Haitian Creole.

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